

claiming that VR was the future of gaming. And heck, they're probably right, VR could very well be the future of gaming, but like much much later in the future.



Obviously Sony's move was understandable, they wanted to bank on the VR hype, announcing Sony VR and a whole bunch of VR titles along with it. You'll also notice that most VR titles are big league AAA games, because they know for a fact that people will buy those. But fact of the matter is, as of right now VR is simply play this game in first person with 360 degrees of viewing angle. Sure you're actively looking around and turning your head and that's definitely immersive, it's a step in the right direction.

We might not get VR the level of say Sword Art Online – an anime for those of you who don't know, and a rather popular one at that. In the anime, characters pretty much lived in the game, they felt, they ate, they fought, everything was as if they were actually there. This is what VR is aiming for and we're far from it.

HTC VIVE

It's not only Sony, even Valve is cashing in on the VR hype. They've dedicated a third of their manpower to VR and progressing the HTC Vive. For big league companies like Sony and Valve to focus on VR, well it means that VR is definitely going places, and a future where we can



actually enter a virtual world might not be too far.

AUGMENTED REALITY

Augmented Reality or AR isn't exactly a new concept. It's been around for a while, however, now that Pokemon GO is all the craze, AR is back in the lime-light. And it's doing far better than VR ever did until this point. In fact, it's threatening to take over the world, given that consumer interest in AR games is at an all-time-high.

POKÉMON GO

So how exactly does augmented reality differ from virtual reality? Good question. So in a virtual reality, you're kind of immersing yourself in a whole different world. It's not quite as we envisioned it – as mentioned above – in the sense VR could be more than



just strapping a headset to your face, but at this point it isn't. As of right now virtual reality is just a visual modification, kind of like an improved version of 3D. What augmented reality does is it augments the way you interact with the world, so it modifies the way you look at your surroundings. It's much more functional in its approach than VR, so you've got more going on with AR than VR, right now anyway. If you were to look at the literal definition of the word augment, it means to improve on something. Not saying that pokemon popping up all over the place is an improvement, but some definitely seem to think so. Ingress was a game much like Pokemon Go, in fact the same people who worked on Ingress worked on Pokemon GO as well, so those who are familiar with Ingress maps will immediately notice the similarities.

INGRESS

So what exactly was it about AR and Pokemon GO that made it such a huge success? Well for one thing, the popu-



larity of Pokemon itself should be credited for pulling in huge crowds, but in order for people to want to continue playing the game, there has to be something new and innovative about it. This is where augmented reality beats virtual reality. While VR right now is simply a visual improvement, augmented reality actually has you doing newer things. The success of Pokemon GO goes to show you that AR isn't out of the competition. It's success very likely means that we'll definitely be seeing more AR titles in the future. It won't be surprising if future models of phones actually come with some sort of AR gear or headset to go along with it. Either way it looks like the future will have us all wearing some kind of contraption on our faces... not sure if that's something we should look forward to, oh well only time will tell.

PLAY ANYWHERE

The renaissance was an age of creative freedom and liberation. People were beginning to explore and venture into new fields and ask the right questions. Much like we're being liberated from the shackles that confined us to a single device or console.

We're not talking just about the Xbox Play Anywhere here, but we'll get to that shortly. What we mean by play anywhere in this case is that we're heading to an age where we can literally play at anytime and anywhere. Everything from our saves to our achievements is now stored on cloud. You can access them from anywhere and all you need is an internet connection, which is pretty